

Maharashtra is one of the most urbanized and progressive States in the country and the State Government has been pro-active in its housing policies and establishing institutions to meet these challenges

Dream Homes For "Aam Admi"

With an underlying goal of providing shelter for all, the Government under the leadership of Shri Vilasrao Deshmukh, prepared an ambitious plan to build 10 lakh houses in two years and took steps for its implementation.

Stringent planning and foresight of the Government has led to the fulfillment of their goals. While implementing the housing policy, Government of Maharashtra adopted a definite strategy. It was decided to prepare a report on the basis of a survey to ascertain how many houses were needed in a particular area, how much land was available in that area, amount of building material available etc. The survey is now underway and almost near completion.

The novel schemes declared by the State Government are very comprehensive and inclusive for low and medium income groups and have been designed for reconstruction of old buildings and chawls. The plan includes people from the economically weaker sections and implementation of these schemes is sure to change the face of the cities in coming years.

- ❖ Ten lakh houses to be constructed in next two years.
- ❖ More than 4.5 lakh houses constructed under various schemes and construction of one lakh houses in progress.
- ❖ Decision to construct five lakh rental houses for those coming to Mumbai in search of jobs.
- ❖ Houses to Above Poverty Line (APL) families through *Rajiv Gandhi Grameen Nivara Yojana*.
- ❖ Three room tenements of 269 sq. ft. instead of 225 sq. ft. under *Slum Improvement Scheme*.
- ❖ Houses with all amenities in Mumbai upto Rs. Four lakh through MHADA.
- ❖ Till March end, 50,000 houses for Backward Class poor for which provision of Rs. 600 crore made.



The State Government's objective of slum-free cities is truly laudable and is being pursued vigorously. As a step further in this direction, one of the largest Slum Redevelopment Scheme for Dharavi has been planned on a Public Private Partnership (PPP) mode and is in the process of getting transformed into a modern township through an estimated private investment of Rs. 5,500 crore.

Maharashtra No. 1 in Urban Renewal



Maharashtra is now the leading State under the Jawaharlal Nehru National Urban Renewal Mission (JNNURM). This programme is being implemented in 14 cities in the State viz. Mumbai Metropolitan Region (8 cities), Pune (2 cities), Nagpur, Nashik (2 cities) & Nanded. Mega infrastructure projects and construction of houses with basic services are the components of this scheme. In case of Maharashtra, nearly half the population (45%) is already concentrated in the urban areas. The current rates of transfer of populations from rural to urban settlements suggest that sooner or later, Maharashtra will emerge as predominantly urban State.

The Government of Maharashtra has submitted 116 project proposals for 10 cities to the Central Government, out of which 74 are under consideration. The Central Government has till date sanctioned a total approved cost of Rs. 7528 crore for 51 Detailed Project Reports (DPRs) for the State. The 51 approved projects covers the urban areas of Greater Mumbai, Thane, Nanded, Waghala, Nashik, Pune and Pimpri-Chinchwad. There are 11 such projects in Mumbai and Thane, 14 in Nagpur, 10 in Nanded-Waghala, 3 in Nashik and 9 in Pune and Pimpri-Chinchwad area. The Urban Development Department has designed an information management system with the help of Mumbai Metropolitan Regional Development Authority (MMRDA) for review and monitoring the approved projects. Monthly targets for the various components of each project have been fixed and these are evaluated on a regular basis. On the basis of this evaluation, the projects and cities are serialized.

The State Government implemented the urban improvement plan in accordance to the agreement made with the Central Government. These include the implementation of the 74th Constitutional Amendment, allotment of planning works to local agencies, amendment to Rent Control Act, reducing